

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case No. 2020-6843

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE AS A LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF COURTNEY MORRIS, LICENSE NO. LPC 14272,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Professional Counselor Examiners ("Board") and Courtney Morris ("Respondent"), as follows:

1. Respondent was licensed to practice as a Licensed Professional Counselor ("LPC") in the State of Colorado on December 18, 2017, having been issued license number LPC 14272, and is currently so licensed.

2. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order ("Order").

3. It is the intent of the parties and the purpose of this Order to provide for a settlement of all matters arising out of the complaint in case number 2020-6843 without the necessity of holding a formal hearing. This Order is a full and final resolution of case number 2020-6843. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

4. Respondent admits the following:

a. Respondent failed to meet the generally accepted standards of care by writing letters of endorsement for emotional support animals without having met the client.

5. By virtue of the admissions in paragraph 4 above, Respondent admits and the Board finds that Respondent violated section 12-245-224(1)(b), and 12-245-229(3), C.R.S., which states:

12-245-224. Prohibited activities--related provisions. (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article 245 violates this article 245 if he or she:

(b) Has violated or attempted to violate, directly or indirectly, or assisted or abetted the violation of, or conspired to violate any provision or term of this article 245, an applicable provision of article 20 or 30 of this title 12, a rule promulgated pursuant to this article 245 or any order of a board established pursuant to this article 245;

12-245-229. Licensee duties relating to assistance animals - definitions.

(3) A licensee shall not make a determination related to subsection (1) of this section unless the licensee:

- (a) Has met with the patient in person;
- (b) Is sufficiently familiar with the patient and the disability; and
- (c) Is legally and professionally qualified to make the determination.

6. By virtue of the admissions in paragraphs 4 and 5 above, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction(s) that the Board believes is necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

ADMONISHMENT

7. On the basis of the findings set forth in paragraphs 4 and 5, the Board hereby admonishes Respondent for violations of section 12-245-224(1)(b), and 12-245-229(3), C.R.S. This Order is effective as a Letter of Admonition, set forth by section 12-20-404(4), C.R.S. As part of the admonishment, Respondent agrees to the following terms as a Board Order:

PERMANENT PRACTICE RESTRICTION

8. Respondent shall not write letters for Emotional Service Animals (“ESA”) commencing on the effective date of this Order.

CONTINUING EDUCATION

9. Within twenty four (24) months of the effective date of this Order, Respondent must successfully complete twenty (20) hours of Board-approved professional continuing education (“CE”) courses in the areas of jurisprudence and ethics. Respondent shall obtain Board approval of the courses prior to enrolling in each course. Upon completion of a course, Respondent shall ensure that a certificate of completion is provided to the Board. These hours of CE completed pursuant to this section shall be required in addition to, and may not be counted toward, the mandatory Continuing Professional Development requirements for an active Colorado license or to meet any other licensure requirements.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

10. Respondent will strictly observe the prohibitions set forth in section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and will ensure that she does not engage in any activities that are prohibited and that she practices in accordance with the generally accepted standards of practice.

11. All expenses incurred or associated with education or any other requirement necessary to fulfill the terms of this Order, shall be the sole responsibility of Respondent and not the Board.

12. In the event Respondent relocates at any time prior to completing the terms of this Order, Respondent shall notify the Board of the change of address within 30 days of the effective date of such change.

13. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

14. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

15. This Order shall become an order of the Board when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

16. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S.

17. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

18. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Board. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

19. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Board, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Board. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Board.

20. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Board.

21. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT



COURTNEY MORRIS
LICENSE No. LPC 14272

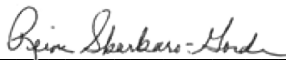
APPROVED AS TO FORM
FOR RESPONDENT



PHILIP M. BLUESTEIN
Rocky Mountain Law Firm

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR
OF EXAMINERS



REINA SBARBARO-GORDON
Program Director

Effective this 22 day of September,
2021.